

INDUSTRY RESEARCH REPORT • JUNE 2026

Malaysia's **Special Access** Pharmaceutical Market

Hospitals, Oncology Centres & the NPP Landscape —
Where Amana Pharma's Expertise Creates Unmatched Value

~360HOSPITALS IN
MALAYSIA**200+**ONCOLOGY-
CAPABLE FACILITIES**43,837**NEW CANCER
CASES PER YEAR**1.5M**RARE DISEASE
PATIENTS

The Opportunity at a Glance

Malaysia's pharmaceutical landscape has a structural gap: hundreds of hospitals need medicines that are not registered locally — and only a handful of specialists know how to source them legally, reliably, and fast. Amana Pharma is one of those specialists.

**USD
292M**

Malaysia oncology drug
market (2024)

14.6%

Annual market growth
rate through 2028

65%

Of cancers diagnosed at
late Stage 3 or 4

491+

Rare diseases listed by
MOH Malaysia

WHAT IS NPP / SPECIAL ACCESS MEDICINE?

A **Named Patient Programme (NPP)** — known in Malaysia as a **Special Access Medicine (SAM)** — is the formal pathway that allows hospitals to obtain pharmaceutical products that are *not yet registered* with Malaysia's NPRA (National Pharmaceutical Regulatory Agency). These are life-saving medicines approved in the US, EU, or Japan, but not yet commercially available in Malaysia.

In Malaysia, this access is governed by **Regulation 15(6) of the Control of Drugs and Cosmetics Regulations (CDCR) 1984**, which permits the importation of unregistered products for treatment of life-threatening illnesses — subject to pre-approval from the Director of Pharmaceutical Services.

Amana Pharma is a licensed, specialist importer operating under this framework. Our regulatory expertise, international supplier relationships, and documentation capability make us the trusted link between hospital pharmacists and the medicines their patients urgently need.

Why This Market Exists and Will Keep Growing

New cancer drugs approved in the US or EU typically take **3 to 7 years** to receive Malaysian registration. During this window, the only legal way for Malaysian patients to access them is through a Special Access / NPP application fulfilled by a licensed specialist importer.

With the global oncology pipeline producing more new molecular entities than any other therapeutic area, and Malaysia's National Rare Disease Policy launched in 2025 expanding formal access to orphan medicines — this market grows larger every year.

Amana Pharma operates at the heart of this gap.

How Many Hospitals Need Special Access Medicines?

Every hospital with a specialist department is a potential customer for NPP/SAM medicines. The larger and more specialised the hospital, the more frequently they need unregistered medicines for their patients.

TOTAL HOSPITAL INFRASTRUCTURE IN MALAYSIA (2024)

Category	Number	Notes
MOH Government Hospitals	148	General, district, and specialist hospitals across all 13 states
Private Licensed Hospitals	207+	Growing annually; concentrated in Selangor (54) and KL (36)
Total Hospitals (est. 2024–2025)	~360–380	Net growth of new facilities since 2022 baseline
Public hospital beds	~46,000	2023 MOH Health Facts data
MOH hospital admissions (2024)	2,712,957	MOH Annual Report 2024

TIERED DEMAND FOR SPECIAL ACCESS MEDICINES

Not all hospitals submit NPP/SAM applications equally. Demand is stratified by specialisation level:

Tier 1 — Highest Demand (~20–30 facilities)

Major tertiary and teaching hospitals: Hospital Kuala Lumpur, UMMC, HUKM, HUSM, National Cancer Institute. Daily to weekly SAM applications. Highest volume, highest urgency.

Tier 2 — Regular Demand (~40–60 facilities)

State hospitals in every state capital with specialist and oncology units: Penang, JB, Ipoh, Kota Bharu, Kuching, Kota Kinabalu. Regular SAM procurement for specialist departments.

Tier 3 — Occasional Demand (~130–190 facilities)

District hospitals, private medical centres, specialist clinics. Occasional patient-specific applications. Growing as specialist care expands to secondary hospitals.

Amana Pharma's Addressable Institutional Market

Combining all tiers, approximately **200 to 280 hospitals and medical centres** across Malaysia actively procure special access or unregistered medicines on a regular basis. Every one of these institutions is a potential client of Amana Pharma — and our existing relationships span across all three tiers.

Oncology Centres in Malaysia

Cancer is now Malaysia's 3rd leading cause of death. With 65% of cases diagnosed at late stage, there is an enormous and growing demand for novel oncology medicines — many of which are not yet registered in Malaysia.

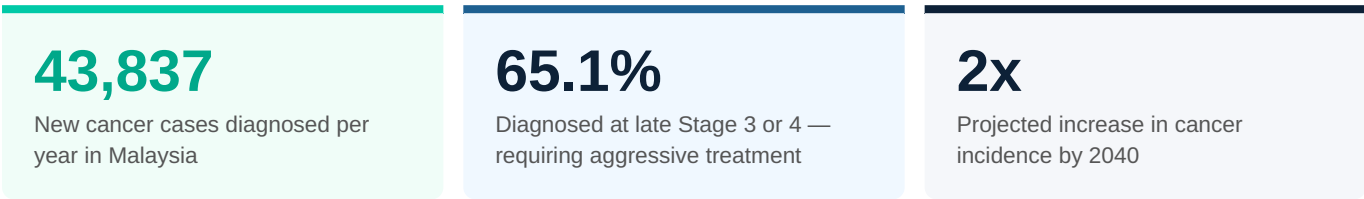
MOH GOVERNMENT ONCOLOGY CENTRES (9 DESIGNATED FACILITIES)

Facility	Location	Role
Institut Kanser Negara (National Cancer Institute)	Putrajaya	National cancer referral centre, comprehensive cancer care
Hospital Kuala Lumpur	Kuala Lumpur	National referral for Radiotherapy & Oncology
Hospital Pulau Pinang	Penang	Northern Malaysia cancer centre
Hospital Sultanah Aminah	Johor Bahru	Southern Malaysia cancer centre
Hospital Raja Perempuan Zainab II	Kota Bharu	East Coast cancer centre
Hospital Tuanku Ja'afar	Seremban	Central Malaysia
Hospital Umum Sarawak	Kuching	East Malaysia — Sarawak
Hospital Queen Elizabeth	Kota Kinabalu	East Malaysia — Sabah
Hospital Sabah Women & Children	Sabah	Paediatric oncology

PRIVATE SECTOR — ONCOLOGY CAPABILITY

- Sunway Cancer Centre
- SJMC Cancer & Radiosurgery Centre
- Prince Court Oncology
- Onco Life Centre
- KPJ Healthcare (30 hospitals)
- IHH (Gleneagles, Pantai, Prince Court)
- Thomson Hospital Cancer Care
- Columbia Asia Oncology
- Ramsay Sime Darby
- Sunway Medical Centre

CANCER BURDEN — THE SCALE OF DEMAND



Top 5 Cancers in Malaysia: Breast • Colorectal • Lung • Lymphoma • Liver

Also significant: Leukaemia, Prostate, Nasopharyngeal, Uterine, Ovarian cancers

Why Late-Stage Diagnosis Drives NPP Demand

When 65% of patients are diagnosed at Stage 3 or 4, they typically need the most advanced, novel treatments immediately. Many of these — particularly targeted therapies, immunotherapy, and CAR-T

agents — are **not yet registered in Malaysia**. The only legal route for their oncologist to prescribe them is via a Special Access application.

Amana Pharma fulfils these applications for over 200 healthcare institutions across Malaysia.

The Regulatory Pathway

Importing unregistered medicines in Malaysia is tightly regulated. Understanding and navigating this pathway requires specialist expertise — which is precisely what Amana Pharma provides.

HOW A SPECIAL ACCESS APPLICATION WORKS

- Oncologist Identifies Unregistered Medicine Need**
A specialist determines that the best treatment for their patient is not available in Malaysia as a registered product.
- Hospital Pharmacist Submits SAM Application**
Under Regulation 15(6) CDCR 1984, the hospital pharmacy department applies to the Director of Pharmaceutical Services for pre-approval to import the unregistered product.
- Director of Pharmaceutical Services Grants Approval**
The application is assessed and, if approved, a permit is granted for importation of the specific product for the specific patient or institution.
- Amana Pharma Sources and Imports the Medicine**
As a licensed importer under Regulation 12(1)(d) CDCR 1984, Amana Pharma uses its international supplier network to source the product, manages all documentation (CPP, CoA, stability data), handles customs, and delivers to the hospital.
- Medicine Reaches the Patient**
The hospital pharmacy dispenses the medicine to the patient under the approved permit.

MALAYSIA'S RARE DISEASE LANDSCAPE (2025)

1.5M

Estimated rare disease patients in Malaysia

491+

Rare diseases listed by MOH Malaysia

<5%

Of rare diseases have an approved treatment globally

Malaysia launched its first **National Rare Disease Policy (NRDP) in August 2025** — a landmark development that is expanding the formal framework for accessing orphan and special medicines. Key developments include:

- National Rare Disease Committee (NRDC) established with subcommittees
- National Rare Disease List officially published
- Malaysian Orphan Medicines Guideline 2020 in active use
- Patient Access Scheme (PASc) — MOH-pharma company collaborations for high-cost medicines
- Health Insurance Department exploring inclusion of orphan drugs in national health insurance (in progress)
- Orphan medicine status milestone: Zolgensma (SMA gene therapy) granted Orphan Medicine status in Malaysia in 2024

What the NRDP 2025 Means for Amana Pharma

As Malaysia formalises its rare disease framework and works toward national health insurance inclusion of orphan medicines, the **legitimate procurement channel for special access medicines grows larger**. Amana's compliance track record, documentation expertise, and supplier network make us the natural procurement partner as this framework matures.

What Makes Amana Pharma Different

Special access medicine supply is not a commodity business. It requires a rare combination of regulatory mastery, international sourcing relationships, documentation discipline, and above all — trust. Amana Pharma has built all four.

THERAPEUTIC AREAS WHERE AMANA OPERATES

- General / Multi-Category
- Oncology & Cancer
- Chronic NCDs
- Rare & Specialty Diseases

THE 6 PILLARS OF AMANA'S ADVANTAGE

1. Regulatory Licence & Compliance

Licensed importer under Regulation 12(1)(d) CDCR 1984. Pre-approved to operate under Reg 15(6) special access framework. NPRA-compliant in all operations.

2. International Supplier Network

Established relationships with manufacturers and authorised distributors in the US, EU, UK, Japan, and South Korea — covering the full pipeline of unregistered innovative medicines.

3. Documentation Mastery

Every SAM import requires a Certificate of Pharmaceutical Product (CPP), Certificate of Analysis (CoA), and stability data. Our team manages this end-to-end, reducing delays that can cost patient outcomes.

4. Special Access Medicine Expertise

Deep knowledge of the application process, timelines, and documentation requirements for Reg 15(6) imports. We guide hospital pharmacists through the process — not just supply the product.

5. Institutional Trust

Serving hospitals, medical centres, and institutional buyers — not retail channels. Our clients are hospital pharmacists and procurement professionals who require a partner they can rely on for life-critical supply.

6. Orphan & Rare Disease Access

Experience with high-cost, low-volume orphan medicines. As PAsC and the NRDP 2025 expand formal rare disease access, Amana is positioned as the compliant importer of choice for these products.

KEY THERAPY CATEGORIES FOR SPECIAL ACCESS — AMANA'S FOCUS

Category	Examples	Why SAM is Needed
Targeted Cancer Therapies	EGFR inhibitors, ALK inhibitors, CDK4/6, PARP inhibitors	Many newly approved drugs take 3–7 years for Malaysian registration
Immunotherapy / Checkpoint Inhibitors	PD-1, PD-L1, CTLA-4 inhibitors; CAR-T agents	Fastest-growing oncology segment; registration lag is highest here
Haematology	AML, CLL, multiple myeloma novel agents	Rapid innovation pipeline outpaces local registration
Paediatric Oncology	Childhood leukaemia, solid tumours	Very few dedicated paediatric formulations registered in Malaysia
Enzyme Replacement Therapies	Gaucher, Fabry, Pompe diseases	Orphan medicines; high cost, limited availability, often unregistered
Gene & Cell Therapies	SMA (Zolgensma), early-access gene therapies	Newest category — regulatory pathway in early development in Malaysia

Market Size & Growth Outlook

The Malaysian oncology and special access pharmaceutical market is one of the fastest-growing healthcare segments in Southeast Asia — driven by rising cancer incidence, a 15.2% CAGR in targeted therapy demand, and an expanding rare disease policy framework.

USD 292M

Malaysia oncology drug market 2024

USD 377M

Projected market by 2029

USD 9.2B

ASEAN targeted therapy market by 2031

TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET FOR AMANA PHARMA

Segment	Estimated Facilities	NPP Demand Level
MOH designated oncology centres	9	Very High — daily/weekly applications
MOH hospitals with oncology/ chemotherapy units	60–80	High — regular applications
Private dedicated cancer centres	15–20	Very High — fewer formulary restrictions, more novel drug demand
Private hospitals with oncology departments	60–100	Medium-High
Haematology units (leukaemia, lymphoma, myeloma)	30–50	High — novel agents consistently needed
Rare disease and metabolic clinics	20–30	Medium — high value, lower volume
TOTAL FACILITIES ACTIVELY NEEDING NPP SUPPLY	~200–280	Amana's institutional client base

FOUR FORCES GROWING THIS MARKET

Rising Cancer Incidence

Cancer incidence projected to double by 2040. More patients → more specialist prescriptions → more SAM applications for unapproved novel drugs.

Global Drug Pipeline

Oncology has the world's largest drug pipeline. Every US/EU approval creates a new SAM window in Malaysia before local registration — typically 3–7 years.

NRDP 2025 Expansion

Malaysia's first National Rare Disease Policy formalises orphan medicine access. As insurance coverage for orphan drugs expands, SAM procurement volumes grow.

Private Hospital Growth

207+ private hospitals, expanding oncology services, and private healthcare spending projected to surpass public spending — driving more private-sector SAM demand.

Amana Pharma: The Partner of Choice

In a market where life-saving medicines require specialist regulatory navigation, Amana Pharma is the trusted, licensed, and experienced partner that Malaysian hospitals rely on. We don't just supply medicines — we make access possible.

With over 200 institutional clients, expertise across oncology, rare disease, chronic NCDs and specialty categories, and a proven track record in regulatory compliance — Amana Pharma is uniquely positioned to grow with Malaysia's expanding special access pharmaceutical market.

Research Sources

All data in this report is sourced from official government publications, peer-reviewed journals, and industry databases. Research conducted June 2026.

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Disclaimer: This report has been prepared by Amana Pharma Sdn Bhd for informational and strategic planning purposes. Market figures represent estimates based on publicly available data sources as of June 2026. Regulatory information is based on current MOH and NPRA guidelines and may be subject to change. This document is intended for authorised recipients only.